

Gender and Society

Comprehensive Weekly Course Reviewer & Study Guide

Course Code: GEND101 / GEC Elective

Coverage: Weeks 1 – 4

Department: Liberal Arts

WEEK 1: LEGAL BASES FOR THE STUDY OF GENDER AND SOCIETY

Legal Frameworks

INTENDED LEARNING OUTCOMES (ILOS)

- Examine the relevance of international and national legal bases that lead toward the study of gender and society.
- Explain key gender-related provisions, executive mandates, and policies significant to gender education in the Philippines.

1. International Treaties & Frameworks

Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination Against Women (CEDAW, 1981)

Adopted by the United Nations General Assembly in 1979 and entering into force in 1981, CEDAW is often described as the international bill of rights for women. It defines discrimination against women and sets up an agenda for national action to end such discrimination.

- **Obligation of State Parties:** Binds ratified countries (including the Philippines) to implement national measures eliminating discrimination in political, economic, social, cultural, and civil domains.
- **Core Purpose:** Serves as a foundational legal framework for addressing systemic gender disparities and advancing substantive equality.

Beijing Platform for Action (BPfA, 1995)

Resulting from the Fourth World Conference on Women in Beijing, this landmark global agenda establishes strategic goals and actions for women's empowerment across 12 critical areas of concern (e.g., education, health, violence against women, human rights, and the economy).

- **Guiding Role:** Provides actionable guidelines for governments, civil society, and stakeholders to formulate gender-responsive development plans.

2. Philippine Constitutional & Statutory Laws

1987 Philippine Constitution (Article II, Section 14)

States: *"The State recognizes the role of women in nation-building, and shall ensure the fundamental equality before the law of women and men."* Serves as the supreme legal foundation for all gender-related legislation and policy formulation in the country.

Republic Act No. 7192 & IRR (1992) — Women in Development and Nation Building Act

Mandates the integration of women's concerns into national development planning and implementation. Ensures that women active in policy-making and executive decision-making processes receive equitable support and opportunities.

Republic Act No. 9710 (2009) — Magna Carta of Women

A comprehensive human rights law that seeks to eliminate discrimination through the recognition, protection, and fulfillment of women's rights—especially marginalized sectors. Covers civil, political, economic, workplace, and social rights.

3. Commission on Higher Education (CHED) Policies

- **CMO No. 20, s. 2013 (General Education Curriculum):** Reconfigured the General Education Framework to foster holistic understandings, intellectual capability, and civic competencies among tertiary students.
- **CMO No. 01, s. 2015:** Explicitly mandates Higher Education Institutions (HEIs) to mainstream Gender and Development (GAD) perspectives into their curricula, research agendas, policies, and community outreach.

WEEK 2: SEX AND GENDER FOUNDATIONS & IDENTITIES

Concepts & Spectrum

INTENDED LEARNING OUTCOMES (ILOS)

- Differentiate clearly between sex (biological) and gender (socially constructed).
- Understand the spectrum of gender identities, gender expressions, and non-binary umbrella terms.

1. Defining Sex vs. Gender

Dimension	Sex (Biological)	Gender (Social Construct)
Definition	Biological and physiological characteristics that define male and female categories (WHO; EIGE).	Psychological, social, and cultural meanings assigned to maleness and femaleness (Keissler & McKenna, 1978).
Key Features	Chromosomes, sex hormones, gonads, internal/external genitalia. Inherited & physiological.	Roles, behaviors, expectations, and personal self-conception. Dynamic and context-dependent.
Cultural View	Universal across human populations.	Configured through social interaction (West & Zimmerman, 1987); reflects <i>loob</i> (internal) and <i>labas</i> (external) (Salazar, 1985).

2. Sexual Characteristics Table

Category	Male Characteristics	Female Characteristics
Primary (Gonads & Hormones)	Testes, Testosterone, Seminal Vesicles	Ovaries, Estrogen, Vagina
Secondary (Anatomical)	Scrotum, Broad shoulders, Facial hair	Labia/Vulva, Wider pelvis, Mammary development

3. Gender Identity Spectrum & Expressions

Gender Identity: An individual's deeply felt internal sense of who they are (Peralta et al., 2019).

Gender Expression: How one presents gender outwardly through behavior, clothing, hairstyle, voice, or mannerisms (Human Rights Campaign, 2023).

Key Gender Identities

Cisgender / Cis

Gender identity aligns consistently with the sex assigned at birth.

Agender

Identifying as having no gender or feeling neutral/without gender identity.

Transgender / Trans

Gender identity differs from assigned sex at birth (e.g., Transwoman, Transman).

Bigender

Experiencing two distinct gender identities (simultaneously or alternating).

Transexual

Transgender individuals who seek or undergo medical intervention (surgery/hormones) to align bodily traits with identity.

Genderflux

Experiencing gender identity that fluctuates in intensity over time.

Non-Binary

Identities falling outside the strict binary male/female structure.

Demigender / Androgynous

Partial identification with a gender / expressing a mix of masculine & feminine traits.

WEEK 3: HUMAN SEXUALITY & SEXUAL ORIENTATION

Attraction & Diversity

INTENDED LEARNING OUTCOMES (ILOS)

- Explain how sexuality and attraction are influenced by complex biological and social factors.
- Differentiate among the diverse types of sexual orientation.

1. Understanding Sexual Orientation

Sexual Orientation: Refers to an enduring pattern of emotional, romantic, and/or sexual attraction to persons of a specific sex or gender (Peralta et al., 2019; Planned Parenthood, 2005). It is distinct from gender identity.

2. Spectrum of Sexual Orientations

Heterosexual ("Straight")

Sexually and/or romantically attracted to individuals of the opposite biological sex or gender.

Homosexual ("Gay" / "Lesbian")

Attracted to individuals of the same sex or gender. "Gay" applies to men (and broadly to the community); "Lesbian" refers specifically to female-attracted females.

Bisexual

Attracted to two or more genders, traditionally male and female.

Pansexual

Attracted to individuals regardless of their biological sex, gender identity, or gender expression ("gender-blind" attraction).

Asexual

Experiences little to no sexual attraction to others. May still experience romantic attraction or form deep emotional bonds.

"Discovering one's sexual orientation is deeply personal. It is a process of self-exploration and reflection. We have no right to decide or judge another person's sexual orientation. Let's be sensitive."

WEEK 4: SEX ROLES VS. GENDER ROLES

Socialization & Expectations

INTENDED LEARNING OUTCOMES (ILOS)

- Distinguish between biological sex roles and social gender roles.
- Analyze traditional sex and gender role expectations in the Philippine socio-cultural setting.

1. Comparative Analysis: Sex Role vs. Gender Role

Feature	Sex Role	Gender Role
Basis	Biological composition, anatomy, and physiological capabilities.	Societal expectations, cultural norms, and learned behaviors.
Flexibility / Change	Immutable: Biological sex roles cannot be naturally interchanged.	Dynamic: Can evolve across cultures, generations, and individual circumstances.
Female Examples	Pregnancy, Childbirth, Lactation / Breastfeeding.	Caregiver, Homemaker, Nurturer, Peacemaker, Patient support.
Male Examples	Sperm production, Impregnation.	Breadwinner, Stoic protector, Primary decision-maker, Leader.

2. Traditional Stereotypes vs. Modern Nuance

While traditional Philippine society assigned rigid expectations (e.g., men as sole breadwinners and women as primary homemakers), modern socio-economic shifts, legal reforms (e.g., Magna Carta of Women), and educational initiatives promote egalitarian role sharing in career, domestic life, and governance.